ADR-5: PIN Handling on Shared Devices

Status

Accepted

Context

STEMMate is designed for facilitators who may use shared devices such as tablets, smartphones, or community computers. User data must remain protected after a facilitator finishes using the application.

Options Considered

Option 1: Keep users permanently signed in

Pros:

- Faster access

Cons:

- High privacy risk
- Anyone using the device can view stored information

Option 2: Store plain PIN locally

Pros:

- Easy implementation

Cons:

- Security vulnerability
- PIN can be exposed

Option 3: PIN-based authentication with session locking

Pros:

- Better privacy protection
- Supports shared devices
- Prevents unauthorized access after sign-out

Cons:

- User must enter PIN again

Decision

The project will use PIN-based authentication with session locking on sign-out.

Consequences

- Improved privacy and security
- Alignment with project requirements
- Slight increase in authentication effort